

THE

INTERNATIONAL CHRISTIAN FELLOWSHIP

Membership, Mission &
Some Statements of Belief

"All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age."

MATTHEW 28:18–20

A PUBLICATION OF THE ICF CHURCH FAMILY

WELCOME

A Word Before You Begin

Many Christians attend churches without knowing what the core beliefs of the church are. It is necessary for a believer to know what their church believes on various principal issues of the Christian faith, in order to avoid false teaching and doctrines and practices which are unbiblical. In ICF, our guiding principle is to follow the teachings of Christ as contained in the Holy Scriptures, the Bible.

Below, we set out a statement of beliefs upon which our faith as a church is founded, together with the biblical references which support and highlight them — alongside what it means to belong to, and serve within, the ICF family.

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PART ONE

Belonging to the ICF Family

"By this all will know that you are My disciples, if you have love for one another."

JOHN 13:35, NKJV

Belonging Calling Foundation

BELONGING TO ICF — I

Benefits of Being a Member

Being a member of ICF ministry is more than just being a member of an organisation or a club.

- As a member of ICF you automatically become a member of the body of Christ.
- You will be supported in prayer — the church is committed to praying for all members and any special needs brought to the leaders.
- You will be developed and trained as a Christian leader.
- Your opinions will be valued and welcomed.
- You can use the church leadership for reference purposes and recommendations in employment or education applications, or for a character reference when required.
- Church ministers will be there for you and your family during naming, dedications, baptisms, wedding/marriage ceremonies, memorials, and funerals, whenever required.
- You will have opportunity to be a partner in ministry, give to its vision, and develop to be one of its leaders.
- You will be loved and cared for by others in the church.
- You will be provided with opportunities and environment to grow to Christian maturity and to discover and use your spiritual gifts.
- You will receive regular Christian teachings and other teachings to help you progress.
- You will receive counselling and direction.
- You will receive spiritual, moral and some material support where possible during crisis, illness, bereavement, etc.
- You will receive regular newsletters, teaching materials, prayer letters and members' information.

There are many other benefits available to members of ICF which you will come to know and appreciate as a member.

BELONGING TO ICF — II

Responsibilities of Being a Member

ICF is a ministry under God. The church is the body of Christ. It is therefore a privilege and an honour to be a member of ICF church and ministry.

For a body to function well, it should be healthy, united, and act in cooperation. By becoming a member of ICF, one begins to enjoy the privileges of being part of the family of God. In addition, a person becomes committed to certain things necessary for the growth and wellbeing of the church, ministry, and family of God.

In uniting himself or herself with the ICF church family, one makes a commitment to do the following:

1. To Protect the Unity of the Church and Ministry

- ✓ by acting in love towards other members
- ✓ by handling problems in a Scriptural manner and refusing to take part in gossiping
- ✓ by following, praying for, and supporting the leaders of the ministry
- ✓ by resolving any disputes in a Godly way, without allowing hatred and disunity

> *By this all will know that you are My disciples, if you have love for one another.*
>
> JOHN 13:35, NKJV

> *These six things the LORD hates... a false witness who speaks lies, and one who sows discord among brethren.*
>
> PROVERBS 6:16, 19, NKJV

BELONGING TO ICF — II

Responsibilities, Continued

> *Obey your leaders and submit to their authority. They keep watch over you as men who must give an account, that their work may be a joy and not a burden.*
>
> HEBREWS 13:17, NIV

> *Let the elders who rule well be counted worthy of double honour, especially those who labour in the word and doctrine… do not receive an accusation against an elder except from two or three witnesses. Those who are sinning, rebuke in the presence of all, that the rest may also fear.*
>
> 1 TIMOTHY 5:17, 19–20, NKJV

2. To Share the Responsibility of My Church

- ✓ by praying for its growth
- ✓ by inviting and bringing new people into the church, encouraging their regular attendance, and warmly welcoming those who visit
- ✓ by sharing Christ with those who do not know Him
- ✓ by financially supporting the work of ministry, giving offerings and tithe, and any special giving

> *We give thanks to God always for you all, making mention of you in our prayers.*
>
> 1 THESSALONIANS 1:2, NKJV

> *Go into all the world and preach the gospel to every creature.*
>
> MARK 16:15, NKJV

BELONGING TO ICF — II

Responsibilities, Continued

3. To Take Part in Serving in the Ministries Within My Church

- ✓ by discovering my gifts and talents and using them in the ministry
- ✓ by being willing to learn and being equipped to serve by my pastors and leaders
- ✓ by developing a servant's heart

> *Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others. Your attitude should be the same as that of Christ Jesus, who took on the very nature of a servant.*
>
> PHILIPPIANS 2:3–4, 7, NIV

4. To Support the Testimony of My Church

- ✓ by attending worship services regularly and faithfully
- ✓ by taking part in at least one other activity of the ministry
- ✓ by living a godly life
- ✓ by speaking on behalf of other members of the ministry against malicious gossip

> *Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works and glorify your Father in heaven.*
>
> MATTHEW 5:16, NKJV

> *Now about the collection for God's people: on the first day of every week, each one of you should set aside a sum of money in keeping with his income.*
>
> 1 CORINTHIANS 16:1–2A, NIV



PART TWO

Our Calling as a Ministry

"Honour the Lord with your possessions, and with the first fruits of all your increase."

PROVERBS 3:9, NKJV

Belonging Calling Foundation

OUR CALLING — III

The Mission of the ICF

> *Honour the Lord with your possessions, and with the first fruits of all your increase.*
>
> PROVERBS 3:9, NKJV

ICF was born out of God's prophetic word to bring people from nations together and raise them into a special people for God, equipped for the work of ministry and living victorious lives — bearing a testimony to the world of what God can do.

God spoke and confirmed His word through prophecies, and in practical ways, leading to the establishment of the ministry and the church.

Our Mission and Mandate as a Ministry Include the Following

- Equipping and training believers for the Work of Ministry
- Raising and preparing members for Victorious Living
- Making disciples through effective evangelism and teaching
- Church Planting — extending the kingdom of God and providing fellowships and centres for worship and spiritual growth
- Outreaching to the community and the needy, with compassion, love, care, and social responsibility

In ICF we are always aware that our main purpose is:

to please God, do His will, and glorify Jesus Christ.

OUR CALLING — IV

Our Mission Statements

Some of our mission statements are highlighted below.

Evangelism

It is our mission and purpose to share the Good News of Jesus Christ with the residents of our cities, nation, and many nations of the world, and see many of them experience new and changed lives in Jesus Christ. It is our mission and purpose to be a place where everybody — including those who are hurting, struggling, or lonely — find love, acceptance, guidance, forgiveness, hope, and restoration. Every ICF member is encouraged to invite at least one person a month to the church and fellowship; bringing in at least twelve people in one year by a member is an achievement worth mention.

Worship

It is our mission and purpose to be a place where people worship in spirit and in truth, where the presence of God is felt and ministers to people, and where experiential worship produces tangible, life-changing results.

Love

It is our mission and purpose to be a truly loving church. We will strive to demonstrate that we are true followers of Christ by loving both those who are a part of this fellowship and those who are outside of this fellowship within our reach. Our sense of unity, practical care, and concern for one another — and refusing to backbite or gossip about them — will be evidence of our love.

Discipleship

It is our mission and purpose to help people experience true life change by growing towards spiritual maturity through preaching/teaching, training, prayer, and group fellowships, among other activities. Every member is encouraged to join learning/training sessions to become mature Christians, in addition to taking part in at least one ministry within the church, as well as being part of the worship service. Personal and corporate prayer is vital to the life of a disciple.



PART THREE

The Foundation of Our Faith

"All Scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness."

2 TIMOTHY 3:16, NKJV

Belonging Calling Foundation

OUR FOUNDATION — V

What We Believe

Many Christians attend churches without knowing what the core beliefs of the church are. It is necessary for a believer to know what their church believes on various principal issues of the Christian faith, in order to avoid false teaching and doctrines and practices which are unbiblical. In ICF, our guiding principle is to follow the teachings of Christ as contained in the Holy Scriptures, the Bible.

Here below, we set out a statement of beliefs upon which our faith as a church is founded, and some biblical references which support and highlight the beliefs.

01 We believe that the Bible contains the written and inspired Word of God.

Psalm 138:2; Matthew 5:17–18; Mark 12:26, 36; Luke 24:27, 44; John 5:39–47, 10:33, 16:13, 17:17; Acts 1:16; Romans 15:4; 1 Thessalonians 2:13; 2 Timothy 3:16; 2 Peter 1:16–21; Revelation 22:18–19.

02 We believe in the authority of the Bible and that it is a sufficient guide for our lives in what we believe, how we live, and how we function as a church and a people of God.

Luke 6:46–49; Acts 15:15; 2 Timothy 3:16–17; Hebrews 4:12; James 1:22.

03 We believe that there is one God who eternally exists in three distinct and equal persons, namely the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

1 Timothy 2:5; Romans 11:33–34; Isaiah 45:21; 2 Peter 1:17; John 1:1, 5:17, 8:58, 10:30–33, 20:28; Philippians 2:5–11; Colossians 2:9; Hebrews 1; Revelation 1:8; John 14:16–17; Acts 5:3–4; 1 Corinthians 4:16; Hebrews 9:14.

OUR FOUNDATION — V

What We Believe, Continued

04 We believe that God is the sovereign creator and ruler of the universe.

Genesis 1:1; *Psalm* 33:10–11, 66:7; *Isaiah* 45:5–12; *Daniel* 4:17, 32; *John* 1:3; *Colossians* 1:16–17; *Revelation* 19:6.

05 We believe in the deity of Jesus Christ, and that He entered this world through the virgin conception and birth and became man. He lived a sinless life. He was crucified and died on the cross as a sacrifice for our sins. He was buried but rose from the dead, ascended to heaven where He is now making intercession for us, and that He will return.

Isaiah 7:14; *Zechariah* 12:10; *Matthew* 1:18–25; *John* 1:1, 14; *Philippians* 2:6–11; *Colossians* 2:9; *Hebrews* 4:14–16; *Luke* 19:10; *Romans* 3:20–26; *2 Corinthians* 5:21; *1 Timothy* 2:5; *1 Peter* 3:18; *1 John* 2:2; *Matthew* 28:7; *1 Corinthians* 15:3–4; *Romans* 4:25; *Acts* 1:9–11; *Mark* 16:19; *Hebrews* 7:25; *John* 14:3; *1 Thessalonians* 4:13–18; *Revelation* 19:7–20:6.

06 We believe in the person of the Holy Spirit, the one who baptizes, fills, and indwells every believer, among His other attributes. The Holy Spirit teaches, guides, comforts, empowers, and develops the character of Christ in believers as they are filled with and walk in the Holy Spirit. He also distributes spiritual gifts and other gifts to the believer and the church. These spiritual gifts must be used in accordance with the Scripture.

John 14:16–17, 16:5–15; *Acts* 1:8; *1 Corinthians* 6:19, 12:1–14:40; *2 Corinthians* 1:21–22; *Galatians* 5:16; *Ephesians* 1:13–14, 2:22, 5:18.

OUR FOUNDATION — V

What We Believe, Continued

07 We believe that Jesus Christ is the Saviour of mankind and the only way to God. Those who receive Christ become children of God. They know God personally as their Father. We are made right with God on the basis of the shed blood of Jesus. All people are born in sin and are sinners by nature and conduct. Our sin has separated us from God; thus we need forgiveness, and to be reunited and reconciled with God through Jesus Christ.

John 14:6; *Acts* 4:12; *Romans* 3:24–26; *Galatians* 4:4–6; *1 Peter* 1:18–19; *Genesis* 1:1, 26–27; *Psalm* 51:5; *Isaiah* 59:2, 64:6; *Romans* 3:9–23, 6:23; *Ephesians* 2:1–3.

08 We believe that all who receive Christ through genuine repentance and faith are born of the Holy Spirit and become children of God, with all of the blessings and responsibilities associated thereto.

John 1:12, 3:16, 5:24, 10:28; *Acts* 3:19; *Romans* 3:21–4:8, 5:1, 8:1–17, 10:9–10, 13; *Galatians* 2:16–21, 3:10–14, 4:4–7; *Ephesians* 1:14, 2:8–10, 4:30; *Hebrews* 7:25; *Jude* 24; *1 Thessalonians* 5:23; *Hebrews* 10:10, 14.

09 We believe that it is the calling of every Christian to live a life of obedience to the word of God, love God and love other people, grow spiritually, use his or her God-given spiritual gifts for the glorification of Christ and edification of the body, and to be a witness for Christ in the world.

Matthew 22:34–40; *Romans* 12:3–8; *1 Corinthians* 12:7; *1 Peter* 1:15–16, 4:10–11; *2 Peter* 3:18.

OUR FOUNDATION — V

What We Believe, Continued

10 We believe that Satan, otherwise called the devil, is a fallen spirit being who, with his fallen angels and/or demons, is against God and fights against God and God's people and against all that is good. However, we also believe that Christ defeated Satan on the cross, and believers have authority over him today.

Isaiah 6; Hebrews 1; Genesis 3; Isaiah 14:12–17; Ezekiel 28:11–19; Ephesians 6:10–18; 1 Peter 5:8; 2 Peter 2:4; 1 John 3:8; Jude 6; Revelation 12.

11 We believe in the bodily resurrection of the righteous and unrighteous, the eternal life of joy and blessedness of the followers of Christ in heaven, and the eternal punishment of the lost in hell.

Matthew 25:46; Luke 16:19–31; John 5:29, 14:3; Acts 1:11; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; 1 John 3:13; Revelation 19–22.

12 We believe that God has ordained the family as the foundational institution of human society. Marriage is the uniting of man and woman in a life commitment covenant. The husband and the wife are equal before God, since both are created in God's image. They are to live in love and harmony, playing their God-given roles and working together to manage their home as pleasing to God.

OUR FOUNDATION — V

The Family

Children are a blessing and heritage from the Lord. Parents are to raise their children with a godly example, loving discipline, wise teaching and training, and proper affection. Children are to honour and obey their parents.

Genesis 1:26–28, 2:15–25, 3:1–20; Deuteronomy 6:4–9; Psalm 127, 139:13–16; Malachi 2:14–16; Ephesians 5:21–33, 6:1–4; Colossians 3:18–21; Titus 2:3–5; 1 Peter 3:1–7.

13 We believe that Jesus Christ is Lord over everything.

Matthew 28:18; 1 Corinthians 15:27–28; Philippians 2:9–11; Colossians 1:18.

Glory and Honour and Power be unto the Lord Jesus Forever

Becoming a Member

Would you like to be a member or partner of ICF? Please speak to one of the leaders for more information — we would love to welcome you into the family.

"All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations…"

MATTHEW 28:18–19, NIV

INTERNATIONAL CHRISTIAN FELLOWSHIP

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